THE POWER OF LOGICAL STRUCTURE
IDEA GENERATION

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SLIDEHEROES

GOLDEN RULE

CREATE IDEAS FIRST, SLIDES SECOND

Develop our initial ideas outside of our presentation tool to ensure they retain their malleability

GATHERING IDEAS AND CONTENT

1 Gather existing content

GATHERING IDEAS AND CONTENT

1. Gather existing content
2. Expand and improve on existing content

GATHERING IDEAS AND CONTENT

1. Gather existing content
2. Expand and improve on existing content
3. Create new analysis

TWO TECHNIQUES

BRAINSTORMING

VISUAL THINKING TOOLS

Idea Generation

BRAINSTORMING

FURTHER READING

THE NEW YORKER

SUBSCRIBE | MAGAZINE | NEWS | CULTURE | POLITICS | BOOKS | SCIENCE & TEC

ARCHIVE | WORLD CUP | DAILY COMMENT | AMY DAVIDSON | ANDY BOROWITZ | JOHN CASSIDY

ANNALS OF IDEAS

GROUPTHINK

The brainstorming myth.

BY JONAH LEHRER

JANUARY 30, 2012

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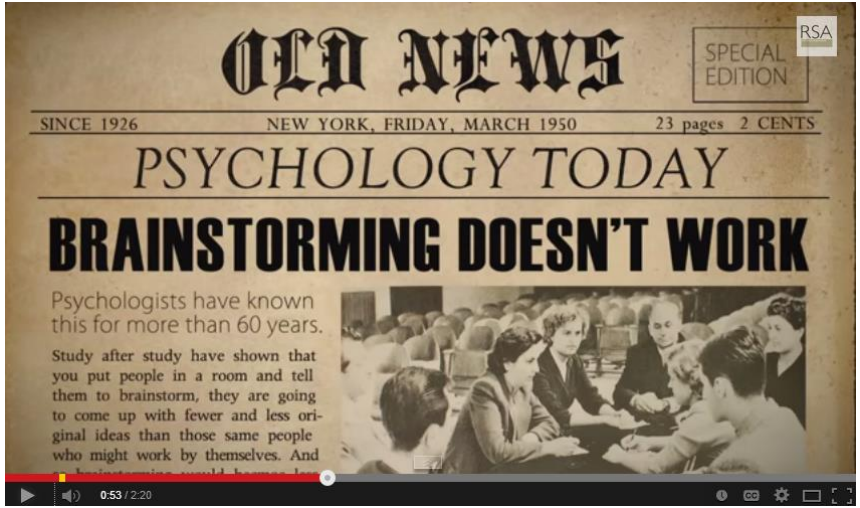
In the late nineteen-forties, Alex Osborn, a partner in the advertising agency B.B.D.O., decided to write a book in which he shared his creative secrets. At the time, B.B.D.O. was widely regarded as the most innovative firm on Madison Avenue. Born in 1888, Osborn had spent much of his career in Buffalo, where he started out working in newspapers, and his life at B.B.D.O. began when he teamed up with another young adman he'd met volunteering for the United War Work Campaign. By the forties, he was one of the industry's grand



Idea Generation

READ NEW YORKER ARTICLE – I'LL WAIT

BRAINSTORMING RESEARCH CONCLUSIONS

1. Less effective than solo, independent creative thinking

BRAINSTORMING RESEARCH CONCLUSIONS

1. Less effective than solo, independent creative thinking

2. Groups that engage in debate and dissent come up with more ideas and their ideas are more original

RECOMMENDED BRAINSTORMING SEQUENCE

1

STEP ONE
- Brainstorm alone

Engage with topic, capture low hanging fruit

2

STEP TWO
- Brainstorm as part of a group

Utilize the group to identify less obvious, more original ideas

3

STEP THREE
- Brainstorm alone

Take advantage of new lines of thinking

FOUR CARDINAL RULES FOR BRAINSTORMING SESSION SUCCESS

PLAN PARTICIPANTS

- Only invite brains
- No wet blankets

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STRUCTURE SESSION

- Have a plan
- Keep it short
- Get everyone wired-up

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ESTABLISH RULES

- Prohibit potential distractions
- One conversation at a time
- Stay focused on the topic
- Write it down

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FOCUS ON IDEAS

- Engage in dissent and debate
- Suspend judgment / judge
- Go for quantity
- Encourage wild ideas

Idea Generation

VISUAL THINKING TOOLS

VISUAL THINKING ANALOGUE TOOLS

A Index cards

Downloaded online graphics at www.pngwing.com

Our analytics SaaS product is a new entrant

- We have achieved $10 million in annual recurring revenue
- Grew 20% last year
- Growth targets for next year are 30%
- Projecting a shortfall

Product manager has recommended raising prices

- John has suggested raising prices
- Forecasts a 10% increase in price closing the revenue projection shortfall

We should not raise prices

- We are the highest priced player
- Planned retention hook features are not yet deployed
- Substantial evidence of price sensitivity in market

We should introduce a lower priced service option

- Lower priced option, with greatly limited feature set
- Self-service support
- Few low priced SaaS alternatives on the market

This approach has the potential to unlock a huge, previously addressable market

- Student, SME markets very large
- Reference Gartner data
- Cannot crack this market with current product configuration

The strategy could drive $10 million in annual revenue

- 1% share, growing to 7% by year five
- Closes revenue gap next year
- Driving dramatic growth in years 4 and 5

VISUAL THINKING ANALOGUE TOOLS

A Index cards

B Sticky ‘Post-It’ notes

Introduction

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Lower priced option, with greatly limited feature set

Has the potential to unlock a huge, previously addressable market

Could drive $10 million in annual revenue

VISUAL THINKING ANALOGUE TOOLS

A Index cards

B Sticky ‘Post-It’ notes

C Mind maps

Connective Leadership

THEY SAY "BE BETTER THAN ME" CONNECTIVE LEADERSHIP-A TALK-BY JEAN LIPMAN-BLUMEN

"Something is on the way out and something else is being painfully born. It is as if something were crumbling, decaying, exhausting itself while something else still INDISTINCT were arising from the rubble" VACLAV HAVEL, Connective Leader

Overview

C.L BEHAVIOURS

- ACHIEVING
- STYLES
- AUTOCRATIC
- MEDIATE
- PERSUADE
- NEGOTIATE
- TAKE OTHERS DREAMS/VISIONS INTO ACCOUNT
- DECISIONS
- VISIONS
- ACT
- NETWORKS
- SPECIFIC
- PROBLEMS
- GOALS
- ALITIONS SHIFTING CREATE

Defy Expectations, Make friends of enemies. Create possibility of change and Inspires Imagination

OUNTER-INTUITIVELY

ERAS

1. Geopolitic)(II)
   - Connective(III)
   - FROM TO
   - Leader
2. Conditions
   - Para
   - MIXTU
3. "Achieving St
   - "Connective

Everyone has an untapped reservoir of leadership ability

BEHAVIOURS

STAKEHOLDERS

- UNIQUENESS
- INDIVIDUALITY
- SEPARATENESS
- DIVERSITY
- MANY
- FUTURE
- PAST
- POLITICAL
- GEOGRAPHIC
- BOUNDARIES

Effective Connective Leaders will integrate these divergent forces into coherent, meaningful action

Each force in and of itself increases your yearning for the opposite

- OPPOSITES
- BUILD
- SHARED
- COMMONALITY
- NEEDS
- GOALS
- INTERDEPENDENCE

CONNECTIVE (III)

1. GEOPOLITICAL (II)
   - SHAPED BY
   - PERMANENT COALITIONS
   - e.g. NATO,New Deal
   - RELEVANT RESOURCES DECIDE
   - ECONOMIC
   - POLITICAL, MILITARY,
   - DOMINANT
   - GRAND VISION
   - Authoritarian
   - Cold War France considered "difficult" Too individualistic - They balked at towing line
   - Orthodoxy
   - CONFORM
   - OBEDIENCE
   - ADHERE
   - DIRECTIVE "NO"
   - Interdependence/Diversity "YES" Obedience "NO"
   - Everything/Everyone LINKED
   - METAPHOR
   - CONDITIONS
   - CHANGING
   - INTENSE
   - COMPLEX
   - YES
   - THINK GLOBAL
   - Alliances, Partnerships, Joint Ventures, Temp Coalitions NETWORKS
   - Membership
   - COMMUNITY
   - COLLABORATION

iMindMap created by Sharon Curry TLI (ThinkBuzan Licensed Instructor). Director, European Institute for Leadership EIL

VISUAL THINKING ANALOGUE TOOLS

A Index cards

B Sticky ‘Post-It’ notes

C Mind maps

D Hanging folders

Idea Generation

BIG IDEAS

LESSON SUMMARY

CREATE IDEAS FIRST

Create ideas first, slides second

LEVERAGE EXISTING CONTENT

Gather existing content, and improve on it in addition to doing new analysis

BRAINSTORM ALONE & IN GROUPS

Solo brainstorming can be very effective

ENGAGE IN DEBATE AND DISSENT

Improves the effectiveness of brainstorming sessions

4 BRAINSTORMING RULES

Plan participants, structure session, establish rules, and focus on ideas

USE VISUAL THINKING TOOLS

Use tools like index cards, sticky notes, mind maps and hanging folders